

SHM 102 Course Blueprint

Yoni Rodriguez

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Course Purpose

SHM 102 introduces students to the foundational concepts and reasoning used to understand occupational health problems. The course develops a common language for recognizing occupational hazards, understanding how workers are exposed, identifying potential health effects, evaluating factors that influence risk, and considering strategies for prevention and control.

Rather than examining workplace hazards in isolation, students explore how worker health is shaped by interactions among environmental conditions, public policy, communities, workplaces, individual behaviors and susceptibility, and biological processes.

By the end of the course, students should be able to recognize occupational health problems, investigate how and why they occur, evaluate evidence, and propose practical approaches for protecting worker health.

Course Philosophy

Occupational health problems rarely exist in isolation. SHM 102 therefore uses a systems based, case study approach rather than organizing the course exclusively around individual hazard categories.

The course moves repeatedly between scales:

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graph TD; A[Climate & Environment] --> B[Society & Policy]; B --> C[Community Health]; C --> D[Workplace Environment]; D --> E[Worker Health & Behaviors]; E --> F[Cells, Molecules & Microorganisms];
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Climate & Environment
↓
Society & Policy
↓
Community Health
↓
Workplace Environment
↓
Worker Health & Behaviors
↓
Cells, Molecules & Microorganisms

Students practice a common occupational health reasoning framework:

Core Concepts

Students develop foundations in occupational and environmental health, history and policy, major hazard categories, exposure pathways and routes, dose and exposure characteristics, risk and susceptibility, prevention, and the hierarchy of controls.

Fall 2026 Course Offering

Course Information

Item	Fall 2026
Course	SHM 102: Occupational Health
Section	001
Credits	5
Instructor	Yoni Rodriguez, Assistant Professor
Meeting days	Monday through Thursday
Meeting time	9:00 to 9:50 AM
Classroom	Hogue 102 through September 29; Hogue 229 beginning September 30
Instructional format	In person

The small class size allows the course to use more seminar style discussion, reading discussions, collaborative case analysis, and instructor consultation.

Instructional Progression

Foundations

The opening portion establishes the conceptual and historical background students need before independently analyzing occupational health problems. Foundations include what occupational health is, connections to environmental health and public health, historical development, institutions and policy, hazard categories, hazard versus risk, exposure pathways and routes, prevention, hierarchy of controls, and the occupational health reasoning framework.

Case Based Weekly Rhythm

After foundations, a typical week may move from a real problem or case, to scientific concepts, to investigation and application, and finally to synthesis, discussion, or project work. This rhythm is intentionally flexible. The syllabus should identify major milestones and university closures without locking the course into exact weekly topic titles while the first redesigned offering is being developed.

Reading and Discussion Days

The Fall 2026 section may periodically use a class meeting as a seminar style reading discussion. Students may read selected excerpts or short materials connected to occupational health cases and then discuss the worker, task, hazard, exposure, health effect, risk, and control implications.

One planned example is the opening chapter of *The Hot Zone*, used to discuss occupational exposure, field work, infectious disease, and what exposure science can look like outside the United States. Copyrighted readings will be provided through Canvas or another permitted university access method and will not be redistributed through the public course repository.

Reflections

Short Canvas reflections may follow readings, discussions, cases, or other class activities. These are primarily completion based. A student receives credit for a genuine, responsive attempt that engages with the prompt. Blank, unrelated, or nonresponsive submissions do not receive credit. Reflections contribute to Engagement & Current Events rather than functioning as separate high stakes writing assignments.

Fall 2026 Calendar Architecture

The course begins September 23 and the last day of instruction is December 4. Veterans Day is November 11. Thanksgiving and Native American Heritage Day recess affects November 25 through 27. December 7 is Study Day and December 8 through 11 is Final Exam Week.

Course topics and case studies remain flexible. Major assessment and project milestones will be announced in Canvas and reflected in the syllabus.

Assessment Architecture

SHM 102 uses a 400 point course structure emphasizing foundational knowledge, engagement, and application.

Assessment	Points	Percent
Midterm: Foundations	100	25%
Engagement & Current Events	100	25%
Final Group Project	200	50%
Total	400	100%

Grading Framework

CWU defines the institutional letter grades and associated grade points used on the academic transcript. The CWU catalog identifies A and A- as Excellent, the B range as Good, the C range as Satisfactory, the D range as Marginal Pass, and F as Failure. CWU does not list an A+ grade. The catalog defines letter grades and grade points, but it does not prescribe percentage cutoffs for individual courses.

SHM 102 therefore uses the following course percentage ranges to translate the 400 course points into CWU letter grades. These percentage ranges are the grading scale adopted for this course.

Percentage	Letter Grade	CWU Grade Points
94 to 100%	A	4.0
90 to less than 94%	A-	3.7
87 to less than 90%	B+	3.3
83 to less than 87%	B	3.0
80 to less than 83%	B-	2.7
77 to less than 80%	C+	2.3
73 to less than 77%	C	2.0
70 to less than 73%	C-	1.7
67 to less than 70%	D+	1.3
63 to less than 67%	D	1.0
60 to less than 63%	D-	0.7
Below 60%	F	0.0

Source basis: CWU Undergraduate Catalog, *Academic and General Regulations*, “Grading Policies and Regulations.” The percentage thresholds above are course specific and are not presented as university mandated percentage cutoffs.

Midterm: Foundations

The midterm assesses students' understanding of foundational language and concepts needed to analyze occupational health problems. Students should recognize and use concepts rather than rely exclusively on memorized definitions. Potential areas include occupational and environmental health, hazard categories, hazard versus risk, exposure pathways and routes, dose, frequency, duration, intensity, health effects, susceptibility, prevention, hierarchy of controls, and occupational health reasoning.

Tentative timing: Week 5. The exact date will be posted in Canvas.

Engagement & Current Events

Engagement activities provide opportunities to recognize, discuss, investigate, and apply occupational health concepts. Activities may include current event analyses, case discussions, assigned readings, Poll Everywhere, small group exercises, research activities, Canvas reflections, final presentation peer review, audience participation, and other in class participation activities.

Engagement emphasizes meaningful participation and application rather than attendance alone.

Final Group Project

The final group project is the primary application based assessment. Students collaboratively investigate a real occupational or environmental health problem and apply the reasoning framework developed throughout the quarter.

Students should be able to define the problem, identify affected workers or populations, describe relevant work and tasks, identify hazards, explain exposure pathways, evaluate health consequences and factors influencing risk, use credible evidence, recommend prevention and control strategies, apply the hierarchy of controls where appropriate, communicate findings clearly, and explain how an intervention could be evaluated.

Project development occurs progressively through the quarter. Tentative milestones include group and topic selection, evidence search, exposure and health effect analysis, controls and recommendations, presentation development, feedback, and revision. Exact milestone dates will be posted in Canvas.

Week 11 — November 30–December 3

Final Project Presentations

Final projects will be presented individually during the final week of instruction.

- Individual student presentations
- Approximately 3 presentations per class meeting
- Presentations scheduled Monday through Thursday
- 15-minute presentation slots
 - 10–12 minutes presentation
 - 3–5 minutes questions and discussion
- Peer review and audience participation incorporated into Engagement
- Remaining presentation slots may be used for approved rescheduling or presentation re-dos, if needed

End-of-Quarter Period — December 4–11

December 4: Last day of instruction

December 7: Study Day

December 8–11: Final examination period

No regularly scheduled SHM 102 coursework is planned during the final examination period.

This period provides time for students to focus on other final examinations and for completion of grading and approved presentation make-ups, if needed. # Learning and Study Skills Extra Credit

A standing learning and study skills extra credit opportunity is available to all students under the same rules. Students may read an instructor approved chapter from Cal Newport's *How to Become a Straight A Student* or Brown, Roediger, and McDaniel's *Make It Stick* and complete a short Canvas reflection explaining a useful idea, how it relates to their current approach to learning, a strategy they tried, and what they observed.

A maximum of 10 extra credit points may be earned. Extra credit is intended to reinforce learning skills and is not created individually at the end of the quarter for a particular student.

Inclement Weather and Transportation Disruptions

If weather or transportation conditions make an in person meeting impractical or unsafe, the class may move to a remote format or an asynchronous Canvas activity may replace that meeting. Changes will be communicated through Canvas as early as reasonably possible.

Role of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial intelligence is not prohibited in SHM 102. Students are encouraged to use AI thoughtfully as a tool for learning, brainstorming, clarifying concepts, improving questions, and supporting their understanding.

Students remain responsible for the accuracy, interpretation, reasoning, and recommendations contained in work they submit. AI should support rather than replace the student's own thinking. When AI materially contributes to submitted work, students should briefly identify the tool and explain how it was used. Students should verify factual claims and sources rather than assuming generated content is accurate.

Use of AI to misrepresent another person's or a tool's work as the student's own, to fabricate evidence or citations, or to bypass the learning purpose of an assignment may constitute academic dishonesty.

Student Onboarding

Lecture 00, *How to Succeed in SHM 102*, will introduce how the course works, expectations for participation and communication, office hours, grade questions, major assessments, the final project, study strategies, and campus resources. It will draw on practical ideas about planning, focused work, retrieval practice, spacing, and active learning.

Course Repository and Restricted Materials

The public SHM 102 repository may include instructor created lecture QMD files, rendered HTML lectures, figures, student facing assignment instructions, rubrics, vocabulary resources, and other publicly distributable materials.

Student information, student response data, grades, restricted examination questions, answer keys, internal university records, and copyrighted third party materials that cannot legally be redistributed must remain outside the public repository.

Instructor Notes and Reflections

During and after Fall 2026, record elements to keep, modify, remove, and consider for future offerings. The first redesigned offering should be treated as an opportunity to evaluate pacing, cases, reading discussions, engagement activities, assessment design, and project structure.

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